



INSTRUCTIONAL AREA

Customer Relations

PRINCIPLES OF ENTREPRENEURSHIP SERIES

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- “The event will be presented to you through your reading of the 21st Century Skills, Performance Indicators and Case Study Situation. You will have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. You may make notes to use during your presentation.”
- “You will have up to 10 minutes to make your presentation to the judge (you may have more than one judge).”
- “You will be evaluated on how well you meet the performance indicators of this event.”
- “Turn in all of your notes and event materials when you have completed the event.”

21st CENTURY SKILLS

- Critical Thinking – Reason effectively and use systems thinking.
- Communication – Communicate clearly.
- Creativity and Innovation – Show evidence of creativity.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Explain the nature of positive customer relations.
2. Interpret business policies to customers/clients.
3. Demonstrate a customer service mindset.
4. Anticipate unspoken customer needs.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the role of a team member at AI CONNECT SOLUTIONS, a small business specializing in integrating artificial intelligence tools into everyday business operations to improve efficiency and customer relationships. A prospective client (judge), who owns a growing catering business, has approached you during a consultation session to ask about ways to better manage their customer relationships and keep track of follow-ups, referrals, and potential leads.

The client (judge) currently tracks customer information manually using spreadsheets and sticky notes but feels overwhelmed and worried about missing opportunities. Your job is to introduce them to the concept of a Customer Relationship Management (CRM) system, explain its benefits, and address how AI integration can further enhance its functionality.

During this meeting you must:

- Explain what a CRM system is and how it works.
- Highlight key benefits tailored to the catering business
- Introduce how AI integration can provide additional advantages, such as automated reminders, predictive analytics for customer behavior, and personalized marketing suggestions.
- Reassure the client (judge) that a CRM system with AI is worth the investment
- Address concerns about implementation by offering a clear plan for setup

The client (judge) will begin the role-play by asking, "How can I better manage my customers without feeling overwhelmed?" After you have explained the concept of a CRM system with AI integration, shared its benefits, and answered their questions, the client (judge) will conclude the role-play by thanking you for your recommendations.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. What steps would you recommend to ensure a smooth transition from manual tracking methods to using a CRM system?
2. How would you address concerns about data security, especially when managing sensitive customer information through an AI-powered CRM?

Rate the participant's ability to:		Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Explain the nature of positive customer relations.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9-10-11	12	
2.	Interpret business policies to customers/clients.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9-10-11	12	
3.	Demonstrate a customer service mindset.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9-10-11	12	
4.	Anticipate unspoken customer needs.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9-10-11	12	
SOLUTION						
5.	Unique Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
6.	Practical Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
7.	Effective Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAREER COMPETENCIES						
8.	Critical Thinking Think critically to understand and solve problems.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
9.	Communication Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
10.	Decision Making Consider the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSION						
11.	Demonstrate overall career readiness through professionalism, poise and confidence.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
TOTAL SCORE						